

UNIT 1

The Awakening

UNIT 1

The Awakening

UNIT 1
The Awakening

The Journey Begins...

Hi, we are Ammu and Abhi. We have completed our tenth class just like you. Would you like to come along with us on our journey?

1. Ammu: At last, our exams are over! Shall we go trekking to Nallamala hills?

2. Abhi: What! Nallamalla? That is dangerous!

3. Vinny: Come on, Abhi! You always think too much! Let us go. It is going to be fun!



The next morning, Ammu, Abhi, and their friends—Vinny, Sanjay, and Priya—go for the trek. Vinny spots a narrow trail. On Vinny's suggestion they split up into two groups. Vinny, Sanjay, and Priya go one way, Ammu and Abhi go in another way.

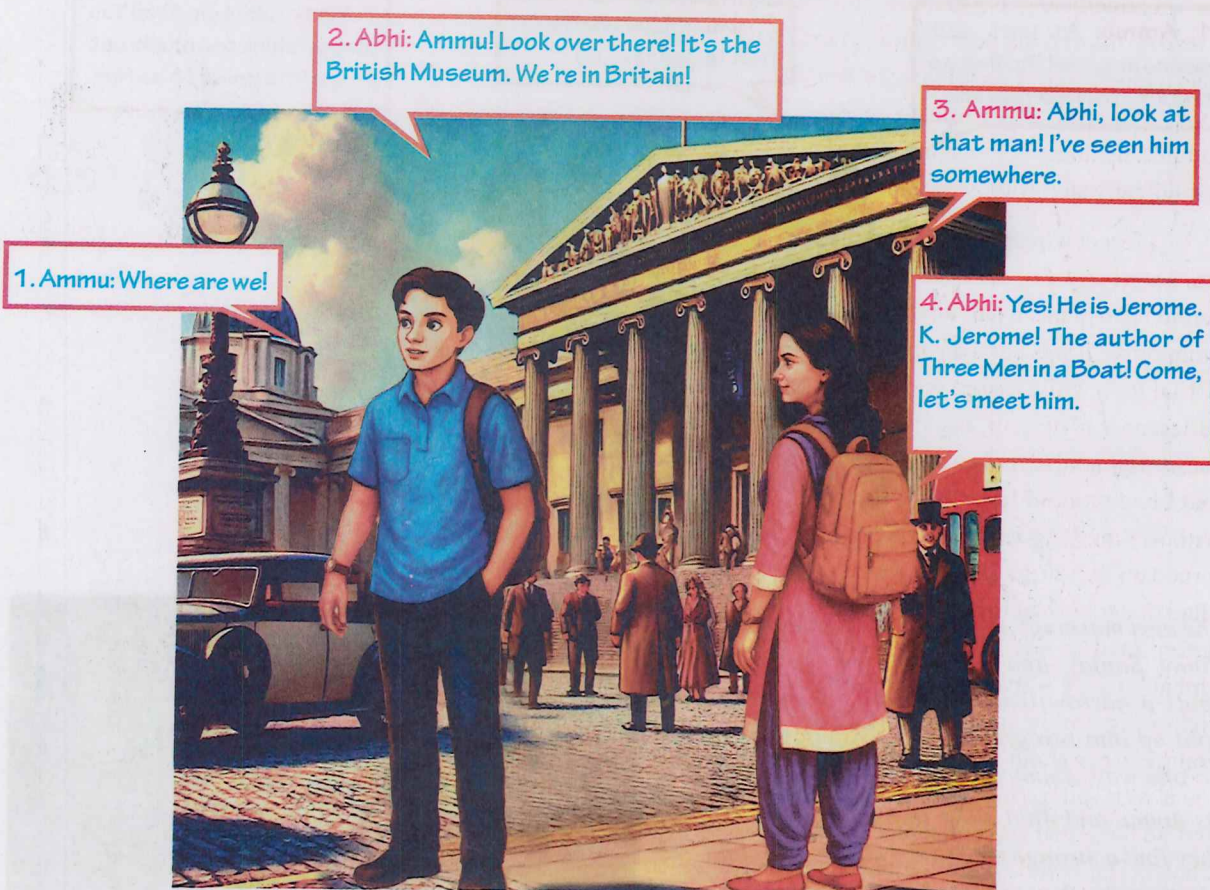
As Ammu and Abhi move through the dense forest, they find a strange machine. No one is around. Out of curiosity, they get into the machine.

The portal shuts behind them. Abhi is scared, but Ammu is excited.



Abhi starts clicking the buttons and levers. The time machine makes horrifying sounds. Suddenly the machine starts falling through darkness. Both are terrified.

The next moment, the machine stops swirling. The alarms and lights turn off. The door opens. They run out of the machine.



Ammu and Abhi:

We will meet Jerome K. Jerome, and have hilarious time with him.
Why don't you enjoy the story along with us?

The Malady of Overthinking

Jerome K. Jerome

The Lesson

I remember going to the British Museum one day to read up the treatment for some slight ailment of which I had a touch – hay fever, I fancy it was. I got down the book, and read all I came to read; and then, in an unthinking moment, I idly turned the leaves, and began to indolently study diseases, generally.

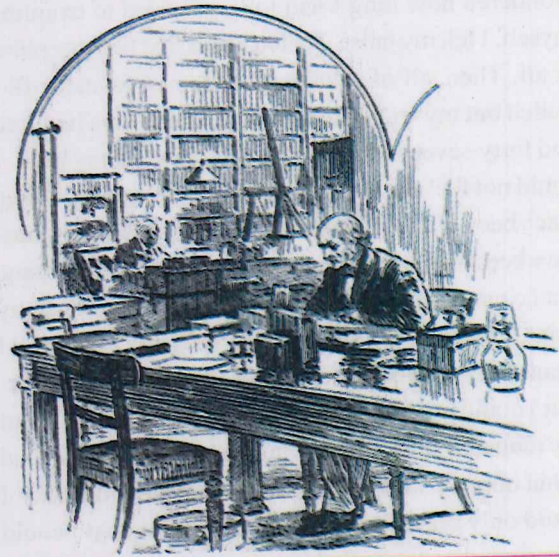
I forget which was the first distemper I plunged into – some fearful, devastating scourge, I know – and, before I had glanced half down the list of “premonitory symptoms”, it was borne in upon me that I had fairly got it. I sat for a while frozen with horror; and then, in the listlessness of despair, I again turned over the pages. I came to typhoid fever – read the symptoms – discovered that I had typhoid fever, must have had it for months without knowing it – wondered what else I had got; turned up St. Vitus’s Dance – found, as I expected, that I had that too – began to get interested in my case, and determined to sift it to the bottom, and so started alphabetically – read up ague, and learnt that I was sickening for it, and that the acute stage would commence in about another fortnight. Bright’s disease, I was relieved to find, I had only in a modified form, and, so far as that was concerned, I might live for years. Cholera I had, with severe complications, and diphtheria I seemed to have been born with. I plodded conscientiously through the twenty-six letters, and the only malady I could conclude I had not got was housemaid’s knee.

I felt rather hurt about this at first – it seemed somehow to be a sort of slight. Why hadn’t I got housemaid’s knee? Why this invidious reservation?

Pause and Ponder

Ammu: Jerome K. Jerome only planned to look up a small ailment, but overwhelmed himself in the end. Just like you.

Abhi: Yes, once I did the same. But have you ever found yourself in a similar situation?



Pause and Ponder

Ammu: This is ridiculous! The narrator feels “hurt” for not having the housemaid’s knee.

Abhi: But why?

Ammu: Maybe we all want to own everything there is, even if it is a list of diseases? I want to watch all animation films, even if some of them are boring!

A man is the product of his thoughts. What he thinks he becomes - M.K. Gandhi

After a while, however, less grasping feelings prevailed. I reflected that I had every other known malady in the pharmacology, and I grew less selfish, and determined to do without housemaid's knee. Gout, in its most malignant stage, it would appear, had seized me without my being aware of it, and zymosis, I had evidently been suffering with from boyhood. There were no more diseases after zymosis, so I concluded there was nothing else the matter with me.

I sat and pondered. I thought what an interesting case I must be from a medical point of view, what an acquisition I should be to a class! Students would have no need "to walk the hospitals", if they had me. I was a hospital in myself. All they need to do would be to walk round me, and, after that, take their diploma. Then I wondered how long I had to live. I tried to examine myself. I felt my pulse. I could not at first feel any pulse at all. Then, all of a sudden, it seemed to start off. I pulled out my watch and timed it. I made it a hundred and forty-seven to the minute. I tried to feel my heart. I could not feel my heart. It had stopped beating. I have since been induced to come to the opinion that it must have been there all the time, and must have been beating, but I cannot account for it. I patted myself all over my front, from what I call my waist up to my head, and I went a bit round each side, and a little way up the back. But I could not feel or hear anything. I tried to look at my tongue. I stuck it out as far as ever it would go, and I shut one eye, and tried to examine it with the other. I could only see the tip, and the only thing that I could gain from that was to feel more certain than before that I had scarlet fever.

I walked into that reading room a happy, healthy man. I crawled out a decrepit wreck.

I went to my medical man. He is an old chum of mine, and feels my pulse, and looks at my tongue, and talks about the weather, all for nothing, when I fancy

Pause and Ponder

Abhi: He is healthy but after reading about the diseases he feels he's a "wreck." (Laughs)

Ammu: Our thoughts and worries can affect how we feel physically. Haven't you ever felt worse after worrying about something?

Abhi: No. I think we suffer more in imagination than in reality. Don't you think so?

I'm ill; so I thought I would do him a good turn by going to him now. "What a doctor wants," I said, "is practice. He shall have me. He will get more practice out of me than out of seventeen hundred of your ordinary, commonplace patients, with only one or two diseases each." So I went straight up and saw him, and he said: "Well, what's the matter with you?"

I said: "I will not take up your time, dear boy, with telling you what is the matter with me. Life is brief, and you might pass away before I had finished. But I will tell you what is not the matter with me. I have not got housemaid's knee. Why I have not got housemaid's knee, I cannot tell you, but the fact remains that I have not got it. Everything else, however, I have got." And I told him how I came to discover it all.

Then he opened me and looked down me, and clutched hold of my wrist, and then he hit me over the chest when I wasn't expecting it – a cowardly thing to do, I call it – and immediately afterwards butted me with the side of his head. After that, he sat down and wrote out a prescription, and folded it up and gave it me, and I put it in my pocket and went out. I did not open it. I took it to the nearest chemist's, and handed it in. The man read it, and then handed it back. He said he didn't keep it.

I said: "You are a chemist?"

He said: "I am a chemist. If I was a co-operative stores and family hotel combined, I might be able to oblige you. Being only a chemist hampers me."

I read the prescription. It ran:

- fruit salad
- three liters of water every day.
- ten-mile walk every morning.
- bed at 10 sharp every night.
- And don't stuff up your head with things you don't understand.

I followed the directions, with the happy result – speaking for myself – that my life was preserved, and is still going on. In the present instance, going back to the liver-pill circular, I had the symptoms, beyond all mistake, the chief among them being “a general disinclination to work of any kind”. What I suffer in that way no tongue can tell. From my earliest infancy I have been a martyr to it. As a boy, the disease hardly ever left me for a day. They did not know, then, that it was my liver. Medical science was in a far less advanced state than now, and they used to put it down to laziness. “Why, you skulking little devil, you,” they would say, “get up and do something for your living, can't you?” – not knowing, of course, that I was ill.

And they didn't give me pills; they gave me clumps on the side of the head. And, strange as it may appear, those clumps on the head often cured me – for the time being. I have known one clump on the head have more effect upon my liver, and make me feel more anxious to go straight away then and there, and do what was wanted to be done, without further loss of time, than a whole box of pills does now. You know, it often is so – those simple, old-fashioned remedies are sometimes more efficacious than all the dispensary stuff.

Pause and Ponder

Ammu: What do you say about that? Is it a good idea to take things easily?

Ammu: Just like the doctor said. Don't stuff up your head with the things you don't understand and you can't control. Keep it cool.

Theme Shopping for Students

Below are the key themes and objectives to learn from Jerome K. Jerome's “Malady of Overthinking.” As you understand each one, mark it off.

- Can you identify and appreciate how Jerome K. Jerome uses humour, exaggeration, and satire to highlight the absurdity of overthinking?
- Have you understood the theme of overthinking and its consequences, as well as the benefits of simplicity in problem-solving?
- Have you found parallels between the narrator's self-diagnoses and modern habits of relying on the internet for medical advice (“Dr. Google”)?
- Have you developed an understanding of new words and expressions within the humorous and exaggerated context of the story?

About the Author

Jerome K. Jerome

(1859–1927) was an English writer, best known for his humorous works. His most famous book, *Three Men in a Boat*, is a light-hearted account of a boating trip along the River Thames, filled with comic mishaps



and absurd situations. Jerome's writing is known for its wit, satirical style, and keen observation of human nature. He often used humour to explore the everyday struggles of life, turning even simple events into funny and memorable stories. Jerome's work continues to be celebrated for its timeless humour and ability to find laughter in life's most ordinary moments.

Dream is not that which you see while sleeping, it is something that does not let you sleep.” - APJ KALAM

The Summary

This lesson is an extract from Jerome K. Jerome's novel *Three Men in a Boat*. In this lesson, the narrator recounts a moment of overthinking when he visited the British Museum to read about hay fever, but ended up diagnosing himself with a wide range of illnesses. After reading symptoms in a medical book, he becomes convinced that he has everything from typhoid fever to St. Vitus's Dance, even though most of these diagnoses are self-inflicted exaggerations. As he goes through the alphabet, he concludes that he has every known malady except housemaid's knee, which he takes personally.

The narrator grows increasingly concerned about his health and imagines how medical students would benefit from studying him as a "hospital in himself." However, after visiting his doctor, who provides a simple and practical prescription of fruits, water, walking, and sleep, the narrator's health miraculously improves. This passage humorously highlights how the narrator's overthinking led him to imagine serious illnesses, only for simple, old-fashioned remedies to bring him relief.

Glossary

- **Acquisition** / ækwɪzɪʃən/ (noun): The act of gaining or obtaining something
Usage: The acquisition of new skills is essential.
- **Ailment** / ˈeɪlmənt/ (noun): A minor illness or sickness
Usage: She stayed home due to a minor ailment.
- **Commence** / kəˈmens/ (verb): To begin or start
Usage: The ceremony will commence at noon.
- **Devastating** / ˈdevə.steɪtɪŋ/ (adjective): Extremely destructive or damaging
Usage: The devastating storm left many people homeless.
- **Grasping** / ˈgræspɪŋ/ (adjective): Greedy or wanting more than one needs
Usage: He was known for his grasping nature.
- **Hamper** / ˈhæmpər/ (verb, noun): To hinder or obstruct
Usage (verb): The heavy rain hampered their journey.
- **Idly** / ˈaɪdli/ (adverb): Without any particular purpose or activity
Usage: He sat idly by the window, lost in thought.
- **Indolently** / ˈɪndələntli/ (adverb): In a lazy or inactive manner
Usage: He lounged indolently on the sofa all afternoon.
- **Induce** / ɪnˈdjuːs/ (verb): Caused or brought about
Usage: The medicine induced drowsiness.
- **Invidious** / ɪnˈvɪdiəs/ (adjective): Likely to arouse resentment or anger in others
Usage: His invidious comments caused tension in the team.
- **Listlessness** / ˈlɪstləsnəs/ (noun): Lack of energy or enthusiasm
Usage: He felt a sense of listlessness during the hot afternoon.

- **Oblige** /əˈblaɪdʒ/ (verb): To do as someone asks or to be required to do something
Usage: He felt obliged to help her.
- **Plod** /ˈplɒd/ (verb): To walk heavily or laboriously
Usage: He plodded through the mud, exhausted.
- **Plunge** /plʌndʒ/ (verb): To dive or fall into something suddenly
Usage (verb): He plunged into the cold water.
- **Ponder** /ˈpɒndər/ (verb): To think about carefully
Usage: He pondered over the decision for days.
- **Reflect** /rɪˈflekt/ (verb): To think deeply
Usage: The light reflected off the glass.
- **Scourge** /skɜː(r)dʒ/ (noun): (noun) A cause of great pain or suffering
Usage: The disease became a scourge for the entire region.
- **Sift** /sɪft/ (verb): To examine or separate carefully
Usage: She sifted through the files to find the information.
- **Zymosis** /zaɪˈmoʊ.sɪs/ (noun): The process of fermentation or the development of an infectious disease
Usage: The rapid zymosis of grapes led to a strong, pungent aroma in the winery.

Contextual Questions

Annotate the following lines in the given pattern

- a. Identify the lesson and name the writer of the given lines.
- b. Discuss the context of the lines and appreciate them critically in about 75 words.
 1. I was a hospital in myself. All they need to do would be to walk round me, and, after that, take their diploma.
 2. I walked into that reading room a happy, healthy man. I crawled out a decrepit wreck.
 3. Don't stuff up your head with things you don't understand. I followed the directions, with the happy result. . .
 4. You know, it often is so – those simple, old-fashioned remedies are sometimes more efficacious than all the dispensary stuff.

Questions

Answer the following questions in about 150 words each

1. Comment on the title of "The Malady of Overthinking" by Jerome K. Jerome. Are maladies of overthinking limited to health? Explain your view.
2. What are the potential dangers of gaining excessive information about diseases as we have seen in "The Malady of Overthinking"?
3. In the context of academic performance and mental health, how useful is the doctor's "prescription" in "The Malady of Overthinking"?

Creative Writing

Using the hints provided, write at least ten lines, expanding the ideas into complete sentences. Be creative!

If I Could Fly...

Idea: Imagine you could fly for one day. Write a paragraph about where you would go, what you would do, and how you would feel.

- Hints**
- If I could fly, I would _____.
 - I would see _____.
 - Along with me, I would take _____.
 - I would try _____.
 - At the end of the day, I would feel _____.

Vocabulary Matching

Overthinker's Dictionary

Sometimes, we come across words that make us pause and think—or overthink! Below are a few words you will encounter in the lesson, along with playful definitions. Match the words to their correct definitions.

Words	Meanings
1. Hypochondriac	a. A place where people go to turn a paper cut into an adventure story.
2. Exaggeration	b. Nature's way of making sure you are never dressed right.
3. Diagnosis	c. When your body decides to turn itself into a furnace, just for fun.
4. Overthinking	d. Someone who would climb a mountain just to prove their cat wrong.
5. Comedy	e. When someone refuses to share their chocolate, even though it is "for your own good."
6. Determined	f. A person who thinks every cough is a sign of doom.
7. Selfish	g. Making a five-minute task take five hours in your head.
8. Hospital	h. Turning a small ant into a giant elephant.
9. Weather	i. Finding humour in someone else's overthinking.
10. Fever	j. Guessing what is wrong and being wrong most of the time.

The Journey Continues.....

Abhi: Get in the machine, Ammu. Our next destination is Paris! The Eiffel Tower!

Ammu: Don't overthink! Let's drive the machine straight to home!

The time machine quickly zooms through space and stops suddenly.

Ammu: What happened?
Why did it stop?

Abhi: I too don't know.
Maybe we came home!
Let's see! Let's go out!



Abhi: Ammu! This is not Vinny's house! This is...

Ammu: Oh my god! Are we in a forest?

Abhi: (*whispering*) Ammu... Is that... a tiger?

A tiger prowls in the distance - its movements are powerful and graceful.

Abhi: (*pulling Ammu behind a tree*) It is looking this way! What if it comes for us?

Ammu: It hasn't seen us. But hey, don't you think it is... beautiful? Like someone had painted it.

Abhi: A painting! It is a predator, Ammu! It'll turn *us* into a painting in its den!

A soft bleat interrupts them. Behind them, a lamb grazes peacefully.

Ammu: Look! A lamb! So gentle, so pure...

Abhi: And dangerously close to the tiger!

Ammu: Don't you see? The tiger, fierce and fiery. The lamb, innocent, and calm. Two sides of life itself!

I. The Lamb

II. The Tyger

William Blake

Poems

The Lamb

Little lamb, who made thee?
Dost thou know who made thee,
Gave thee life, and bid thee feed
By the stream and o'er the mead;
Gave thee clothing of delight,
Softest clothing, wooly, bright;
Gave thee such a tender voice,
Making all the vales rejoice?
 Little lamb who made thee?
 Dost thou know who made thee?

 Little lamb, I'll tell thee;
 Little lamb, I'll tell thee:
He is called by thy name,
For he calls Himself a Lamb.
He is meek, and He is mild,
He became a little child.
I, a child, and thou a lamb,
We are called by his name.
 Little lamb, God bless thee!
 Little lamb, God bless thee!

The Tyger

Tyger Tyger, burning bright,
In the forests of the night;
What immortal hand or eye,
Could frame thy fearful symmetry?

In what distant deeps or skies.
Burnt the fire of thine eyes?
On what wings dare he aspire?
What the hand, dare seize the fire?

And what shoulder, and what art,
Could twist the sinews of thy heart?
And when thy heart began to beat.
What dread hand? And what dread feet?

What the hammer? what the chain,
In what furnace was thy brain?
What the anvil? what dread grasp.
Dare its deadly terrors clasp!

When the stars threw down their spears
And water'd heaven with their tears:
Did he smile his work to see?
Did he who made the Lamb make thee?

Tyger Tyger burning bright,
In the forests of the night:
What immortal hand or eye,
Dare frame thy fearful symmetry?

Theme Shopping for Students

Below are the key themes and objectives to learn from William Blake's "The Lamb" and "The Tyger". As you understand each one, mark it off.

- Have you known who William Blake was, and what kind of poems he wrote?
- Can you identify how "The Lamb" represents a state of innocence, while "The Tyger" explores the complexities of experience, suggesting that creation contains both qualities?
- Have you understood the importance of lines like "Little lamb, who made thee?" and "What immortal hand or eye could frame thy fearful symmetry?"
- Can you summarise Blake's message about the complexities of creation and the interconnectedness of innocence and experience?

About the Poet



William Blake (1757–1827) was an English poet, painter, and printmaker known for his unique, visionary works that explore deep themes of innocence, experience, and spirituality. A central figure in the Romantic era, Blake combined his poetic and artistic talents to create illustrated poetry collections like *Songs of Innocence* and *Songs of Experience*, where he examined the contrasts between purity and the harsher realities of life. Blake is celebrated for his imaginative style and exploration of creation's mysteries, making him one of the most influential poets of all time.

Some of Blake's most well-known poems include "The Lamb" and "The Tyger," which reflect his fascination with innocence and power, as well as *London*, which explores social injustice, and *The Chimney Sweeper*, a poem about child labour. These works, alongside his visual art, capture his deeply personal and mystical view of the world.

Summary

William Blake's poetry offers a profound exploration of the dual forces shaping existence—innocence and experience, gentleness, and power. This contrast is vividly illustrated in "The Lamb" from *Songs of Innocence* and "The Tyger" from *Songs of Experience*. While "The Lamb" embodies purity and divine benevolence, "The Tyger" evokes awe and fear, questioning the boldness of a creator capable of crafting both. Considering these poems together deepens our understanding of creation's complexity, where tenderness and strength coexist as essential aspects of the natural and spiritual world.

In "The Lamb", Blake presents a world of childlike wonder, where creation is tender and benevolent. Structured as a simple question-and-answer, the poem likens the lamb to Jesus Christ, symbolising purity, kindness, and divine care. Through soft rhythm, repetition, and pastoral imagery, Blake conveys the nurturing aspect of creation, emphasising harmony and divine love.

In contrast, "The Tyger" contemplates a more formidable aspect of creation. The poem's powerful imagery and rhythmic intensity evoke a sense of awe and fear. The tiger, with its burning eyes and fearsome symmetry, raises profound questions about the creator's nature. The repetition of "Did he who made the Lamb make thee?" underscores the paradox of a divine force capable of both gentleness and ferocity. The relentless questioning leaves the mystery unresolved, deepening the reader's contemplation of creation's complexities.

Blake's poetic vision not only presents innocence and experience as contrasting states but also as complementary forces shaping existence. Together, "The Lamb" and "The Tyger" highlight the magnificence of creation, revealing how both fragility and strength emerge from the same divine source. Through rich symbolism and striking contrasts, Blake compels us to reflect on the mysteries of the world, suggesting that beauty lies in the harmony of these opposing yet interconnected forces.

Paraphrasing "The Lamb"

Stanza 1 The speaker poses a series of gentle, almost sacred questions to the little lamb, inviting it to reflect on the mystery of its creation. Who gave it life and shaped its delicate form? Who adorned it with soft, radiant wool to shield it from the cold? The speaker marvels at the tender voice bestowed upon the lamb, a voice that fills the fields with joy and wonder, resonating with the harmony of nature.

Stanza 2 In a reverent tone, the speaker reveals the answer: the lamb's creator is called by the same name, "Lamb," a symbol of divine gentleness and purity. The creator's kindness and humility are reflected in the lamb itself, embodying innocence, and grace. With heartfelt blessings, the speaker venerates the lamb, recognizing it as a cherished and sacred emblem of love and divinity.

Paraphrasing "The Tyger"

Stanza 1 The speaker looks at the tiger, burning bright like a fire in the dark forest, and wonders who could have created such a powerful and intense creature. He is amazed by its fierce beauty and mystery.

Stanza 2 The speaker asks where the creator might have come from. Was it from the heavens or somewhere deep and unknown? He wonders what kind of strength and skill were needed to shape the tiger, with its bold and perfect form.

Stanza 3 He imagines the creator shaping the tiger's heart, which would need to be incredibly strong to match its fierce nature. The speaker wonders what kind of determination and courage the creator must have had to make something so intense.

Stanza 4 The speaker questions if the creator was fearless enough to keep going, even while making such a powerful creature. Did he tremble at the tiger's fierce qualities, or did he continue confidently, with skill and bravery?

Stanza 5 The speaker now asks if the same creator who made the innocent, gentle lamb could also have made the fierce, dangerous tiger. He is trying to understand how both gentle and terrifying creatures could come from the same hands.

Stanza 6 The poem ends with the speaker still marveling at the boldness of the creator in making the tiger. The repeated question reflects the speaker's awe and wonder at the creator, who could form something so fearsome yet beautiful.

Words from Old English

1. Thou – You (Singular, when used as the subject in a sentence)
2. Thee – You (Singular, when used as the object in a sentence)
3. Dost – Do
4. O'er – Over
5. Thine – Your or Yours (when used before a vowel)
6. Thy – Your or Yours (when used before a consonant)

Glossary

- **Anvil** /ˈænvɪl/ (**noun**): A heavy iron block used for shaping metal, often by blacksmiths
Usage: The blacksmith hammered the metal on the anvil.
- **Blaze** /bleɪz/ (**verb**): To burn brightly
Usage: Within minutes the whole building was blazing.
- **Burning** /ˈbɜːnɪŋ/ (**adjective**): Glowing intensely; often suggests passion or intensity
Usage: The fire was burning brightly in the dark night.
- **Fearful** /ˈfɛəfəl/ (**adjective**): Inspiring fear or awe; frightening
Usage: The storm was a fearful sight to behold.
- **Fierce** /fɪəs/ (**adjective**): angry and aggressive in a way that is frightening
Usage: a fierce dog.
- **Furnace** /ˈfɜːnɪs/ (**noun**): An enclosed structure for intense heat, often used for melting or forging
Usage: The blacksmith worked in the heat of the furnace.
- **Harmony** /ˈhɑːməni/ (**Noun**): a state of peaceful existence and agreement
Usage: They lived together in perfect harmony.
- **Immortal** /ɪˈmɔːtl/ (**adjective**): live or last forever
Usage: He believed himself immortal.
- **Innocence** /ˈɪnəsəns/ (**noun**): Purity; the state of being free from guilt or sin
Usage: The child is innocent.
- **Lamb** /læm/ (**noun**): A young sheep; also a symbol of innocence and purity
Usage: The lamb wandered freely in the meadow.

- **Meek /mi:k/ (adjective):** Gentle and humble; submissive
Usage: She had a meek and quiet personality.
- **Pasture /'pɑ:stʃə(r)/ (noun):** land covered with grass that is suitable for feeding animals on
Usage: The cattle were put out to pasture.
- **Symmetry /'sɪmɪtri/ (noun):** Balanced and harmonious arrangement; a mirror-like balance in shape
Usage: The artist admired the symmetry of the butterfly's wings.
- **Tender /'tendər/ (Adjective):** kind, gentle and loving
Usage: tender words
- **Tyger /'taɪgər/ (noun):** A poetic spelling of "tiger," symbolizing power, strength, and mystery
Usage: The tyger prowled through the dense jungle.
- **Vales /verlz/ (noun):** Valleys, often referring to lowland areas surrounded by hills or mountains
Usage: The mist settled gently over the vales.

Contextual Questions

Annotate the following lines in the given pattern

- a. Identify the poem and name the poet of the given lines.
- b. Discuss the context of the lines and appreciate them critically in about 75 words.
 1. He is called by thy name,
For He calls himself a lamb.
 2. Little lamb, who made thee?
Dost thou know who made thee?
 3. What immortal hand or eye,
Could frame thy fearful symmetry?
 4. Did he smile his work to see?
Did he who made the lamb make thee?

Questions

Answer the following questions in about 150 words each

1. Compare and contrast the key qualities portrayed in "The Lamb" and "The Tyger." How does Blake use these qualities to express the theme of duality in creation?
2. In both "The Lamb" and "The Tyger," Blake explores the mysteries of creation. How does he use contrasting imagery to suggest that creation encompasses both beauty and terror?

Creative Writing

Using the hints provided, write at least ten lines, expanding the ideas into complete sentences. Be creative!

A Day in a World Without Darkness

Idea: Imagine you are living in a world where darkness doesn't exist; where every moment is filled with unending light. Write a diary entry describing one day in such a world.

- Hints**
- The sun always shines; there's no night to rest.
 - Cities are bustling, even at midnight—time feels endless.
 - Plants grow rapidly, but some animals struggle without darkness.
 - Can we appreciate light if there's no darkness?

Instruction: Write at least 10 lines describing what life would feel like in a world without darkness. Reflect on how it changes routines, nature, and the way you view light itself.

Vocabulary Activity

Here are twenty-two words. Look closely, and you'll find that they form eleven pairs of opposites. Can you identify the opposite pairs and list them together? Here's an example to get you started.

Mystery, Peace, Darkness, Aggression, Simplicity, Goodness, Strength, Purity, Complexity, Harmony, Innocence, Fierceness, Creation, Light, Corruption, Experience, Kindness, Conflict, Gentleness, Softness, Chaos, Destruction.

- | | | |
|------------------------------------|-------------|------------|
| i. <u>Creation and Destruction</u> | ii. _____ | iii. _____ |
| iv. _____ | v. _____ | vi. _____ |
| vii. _____ | viii. _____ | ix. _____ |
| x. _____ | xi. _____ | |

Engaging with the Text

1. Role Play Debate: Creator of the Lamb vs. Creator of the Tyger

- **Goal:** Understand the contrasting tones of the poems.
- **How:** Divide students into two groups. One group speaks as the creator of "The Lamb," and the other as the creator of "The Tyger". Each group explains why their creation is essential, using lines from the poems.
- **Result:** Helps students explore the theme of duality in creation.

Pause and Ponder

Ammu: The tiger and the lamb are just two sides of the same coin.

Abhi: Two sides of the same creation!

Ammu: I think, in this world, nothing can exist without two sides. Even happiness is meaningless in a world without sorrow.

Abhi: Yes! That is what I am thinking. Opposites make life meaningful.



The Journey Continues.....

Ammu and Abhi walk through the forest towards the Time Machine, they talk about the lamb and the tiger. Suddenly they hear a low growl echoing through the forest. They freeze. Turning back, they see the tiger—powerful, and unmistakably hungry—charging towards them, through the shadows.

1 **Abhi:** Run! (panicking) Go, Ammu! Get to the Time Machine. Lock yourself in!

2 **Ammu:** (panting, stopping to help) Take my hand, Abhi! Get up, we'll make it together!

3 **Abhi:** There's no time! Save yourself. I'll distract the tiger—go!

4 **Ammu:** I don't even know how to close this portal!

Ammu hesitates. Tears stream down her face. She runs toward the Time Machine. She stumbles into the machine, frantically pushing buttons with her hands. Outside, she hears the tiger's growls and Abhi's screams.

Suddenly, the Time Machine comes to life. Lights blink, and with a shudder, the machine vanishes into the void. The Time Machine stops after a while. Ammu steps out of the machine, hoping to see Abhi—safe and sound. But the sight before her is not a forest. Ammu desperately tries to start the machine, but it needs charge. Charge needs time. Ammu steps out of the machine.

1 **Ammu:** (mumbling) Is this India? This looks like an Indian marketplace.

2 **RK Narayan:** Who are you, child? You seem to be all alone.

4 **RK:** Friendship! Ah! I think I know a little about friendship and loyalty. Come, I'll show you something.

3 **Ammu:** My... my friend... He is still out there! I've left him in danger! I am not a good friend!

The Blind Dog

R.K. Narayan

The Story

It was not a very impressive or high-class dog; it was one of those commonplace dogs one sees everywhere—colour of white and dust, tail mutilated at a young age by God knows whom, born in the street, and bred on the leavings and garbage of the marketplace. He had spotty eyes and undistinguished carriage and needless pugnacity. Before he was two years old, he had earned the scars of a hundred fights on his body. When he needed rest on hot afternoons, he lay curled up under the culvert at the eastern gate of the market. In the evenings he set out on his daily rounds, loafed in the surrounding streets and lanes, engaged himself in skirmishes, picked up edibles on the roadside and was back at the Market Gate by nightfall.

This life went on for years. And then a change in his life occurred. A beggar, blind in both eyes, appeared at the Market Gate. An old woman led him up there early in the morning, seated him at the gate, and came up again at midday with some food, gathered his coins and took him home at night.

The dog was sleeping nearby. He was stirred by the smell of food. He got up, came out of his shelter and stood before the blind man, wagging his tail and gazing expectantly at the bowl, as he was eating his sparse meal. The blind man swept his arms about and asked, 'Who is there?' At which the dog went up and

licked his hand. The blind man stroked its coat gently tail to ear and said, 'What a beauty you are. Come with me.' He threw a handful of food, which the dog ate gratefully. It was perhaps an auspicious moment for starting a friendship. They met every day there, and the dog cut off much of its rambling to sit up beside the blind man and watch him receive alms morning to evening. In course of time, observing him, the dog understood that the passers-by must give a coin, and whoever went away without dropping a coin was chased by the dog; he tugged the edge of their clothes by his teeth and pulled them back to the old man at the gate and let go only after something was dropped in his bowl. Among those who frequented this place was a village urchin, who had the mischief of a devil in him. He liked to tease the blind man by calling him names and by trying to pick up the coins in his bowl. The blind man helplessly shouted and cried and whirled his staff. On Thursdays this boy appeared at the gate, carrying on his head a basket loaded with cucumber or plantain.

Every Thursday afternoon it was a crisis in the blind man's life. A seller of bright-coloured but doubtful perfumes with his wares mounted on a wheeled platform, a man who spread out cheap storybooks on a gunnysack, another man who carried coloured ribbons on an elaborate frame - these were the people who usually gathered under the same arch. On a Thursday when the young man appeared at the eastern gate one of them remarked, 'Blind fellow! Here comes your scourge.'

'Oh, God, is this Thursday?' he wailed. He swept his arms about and called, 'Dog, dog, come here, where

Pause and Ponder

RK: Why do you think the dog chose to stay with the blind man instead of being free?

Ammu: Because he is kind and friendly?

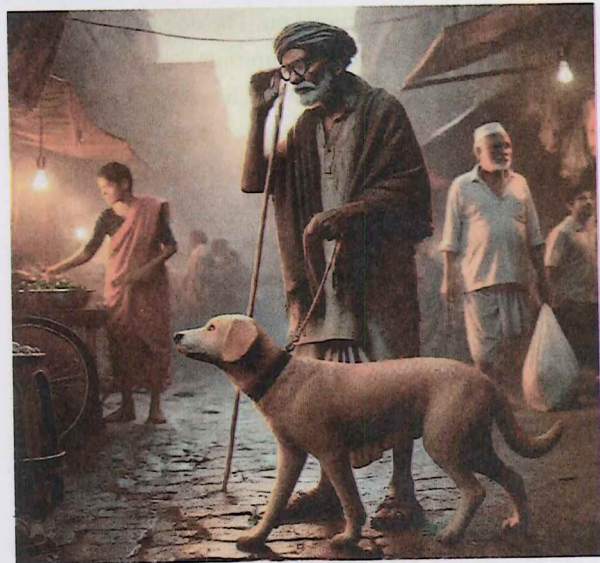
are you?' He made the peculiar noise which brought the dog to his side. He stroked his head and muttered, 'Don't let that little rascal.' At this very moment the boy came up with a leer on his face.

'Blind man! Still pretending you have no eyes. If you are really blind, you should not know this either.' He stopped, his hand moving towards the bowl. The dog sprang on him and snapped his jaws on the boy's wrist. The boy extricated his hand and ran for his life. The dog bounded up behind him and chased him out of the market.

'See the mongrel's affection for this old fellow,' marvelled the perfume-vendor. One evening at the usual time the old woman failed to turn up, and the blind man waited at the gate, worrying as the evening grew into night. As he sat fretting there, a neighbour came up and said, 'Sami, don't wait for the old woman. She will not come again. She died this afternoon.'

The blind man lost the only home he had, and the only person who cared for him in this world. The ribbon-vendor suggested, 'Here, take this white tape,' he held a length of the white cord which he had been selling, 'I will give this to you free of cost. Tie it to the dog and let him lead you about if he is really so fond of you.'

Life for the dog took a new turn now. He came to take the place of the old woman. He lost his freedom completely. His world came to be circumscribed by the limits of the white cord which the ribbon-vendor had spared. He had to forget wholesale all his old life - all his old haunts. He simply had to stay on forever at the end of that string. When he saw other dogs, friends or foes, instinctively he sprang up, tugging the string, and this invariably earned him a kick from his master. 'Rascal, want to tumble me down - have sense.' In a few days the dog learnt to discipline his instinct and impulse. He ceased to take notice of other dogs, even if



they came up and growled at his side. He lost his own orbit of movement and contact with his fellow creatures.

To the extent of this loss his master gained. He moved about as he had never moved in his life. All day he was on his legs, led by the dog. With the staff in one hand and the dog-lead in the other, he moved out of his home - a corner in a choultry veranda a few yards off the market: he had moved in there after the old woman's death. He started out early in the day. He found that he could treble his income by moving about instead of staying in one place. He moved down the choultry street, and wherever he heard people's voices he stopped and held out his hands for alms. Shops, schools, hospitals, hotels - he left nothing out. He gave a tug when he wanted the dog to stop, and shouted like a bullock-driver

Pause and Ponder

RK: What would you do if you are freed from a bad relationship like this?

Ammu: I'll be very happy and I won't look back.

RK: Very good. But you should also heal yourself first.

when he wanted him to move on. The dog protected his feet from going into pits, or stumping against steps or stones, and took him up inch by inch on safe ground and steps. For this sight people gave coins and helped him. Children gathered round him and gave him things to eat. A dog is essentially an active creature who punctuates his hectic rounds with well-defined periods of rest. But now this dog (henceforth to be known as Tiger) had lost all rest. He had rest only when the old man sat down somewhere. At night the old man slept with the cord turned around his finger. 'I can't take chances with you—' he said. A great desire to earn more money than ever before seized his master, so that he felt any resting a waste of opportunity, and the dog had to be continuously on his feet. Sometimes his legs refused to move. But if he slowed down even slightly his master goaded him on fiercely with his staff. The dog whined and groaned under this thrust. 'Don't whine, you rascal. Don't I give you your food? You want to loaf, do you?' swore the blind man. The dog lumbered up and down and round and round the marketplace with slow steps, tied down to the blind tyrant. Long after the traffic at the market ceased, you could hear the night tabbed by the far-off wail of the tired dog. It lost its original appearance. As months rolled on bones stuck up at his haunches and ribs were relieved through his fading coat.

The ribbon-seller, the novel-vendor and the perfumer observed it one evening when business was slack, and held a conference among themselves. 'It

rends my heart to see that poor dog slaving. Can't we do something?' The ribbon-seller remarked, 'That rascal has started lending money for interest - I heard it from the fruit-seller—he is earning more than he needs. He has become a very devil for money.' At this point the perfumer's eyes caught the scissors dangling from the ribbon-rack. 'Give it here,' he said and moved on with the scissors in hand.

The blind man was passing in front of the eastern gate. The dog was straining the lead. There was a piece of bone lying on the way and the dog was straining to pick it up. The lead became taut and hurt the blind man's hand, and he tugged the string and kicked till the dog howled. It howled, but could not pass the bone lightly; it tried to make another dash for it. The blind man was heaping curses on it. The perfumer stepped up, applied the scissors and snipped the cord. The dog bounced off and picked up the bone. The blind man stopped dead where he stood, with the other half of the string dangling in his hand. 'Tiger! Tiger! Where are you?' he cried. The perfumer moved away quietly, muttering, 'You heartless devil! You will never get at him again! He has his freedom!' The dog went off at top speed. He nosed about the ditches happily, hurled himself on other dogs and ran round and round the fountain in the Market Square barking, his eyes sparkling with joy. He returned to his favourite haunts and hung about the butcher's shop, the tea-stall and the bakery.

The ribbon-vendor and his two friends stood at the Market Gate and enjoyed the sight immensely as the blind man struggled to find his way about. He stood rooted to the spot, waving his stick; he felt as if he were hanging in mid-air. He was wailing. 'Oh, where is my dog? Where is my dog? Won't someone give him back to me? I will murder it when I get at it again!' He groped about, tried to cross the road, came near being run over by a dozen vehicles at different points, tumbled and

Pause and Ponder

RK: How do you think the dog feels about this new life?

Ammu: He is making a lot of sacrifices for him, is it necessary?

RK: Attachment and loyalty are powerful than freedom. It is very hard to let go off attachment, even if it hurts.

struggled and gasped. 'He'd deserve it if he was run over, this heartless blackguard—' they said, observing him. However, the old man struggled through and with the help of someone found his way back to his corner in the choultry veranda and sank down on his gunnysack bed, half-faint with the strain of his journey.

He was not seen for ten days, fifteen days and twenty days. Nor was the dog seen anywhere. They commented among themselves: 'The dog must be loafing over the whole earth, free and happy. The beggar is perhaps gone forever.' Hardly was this sentence uttered when they heard the familiar tap-tap of the blind man's staff. They saw him again coming up the pavement - led by the dog. 'Look! Look!' they cried. 'He has again got at it and tied it up.' The ribbon-seller could not contain himself. He ran up and said, 'Where have you been all these days?'

'Know what happened!' cried the blind man. 'This dog ran away. I should have died in a day or two, confined to my corner, no food, not an anna to earn—

imprisoned in my corner. I should have perished(died) if it continued for another day. But this thing returned.'

'When? When?'

'Last night. At midnight as I slept in bed, he came and licked my face. I felt like murdering him. I gave him a blow which he will never forget again,' said the blind man. 'I forgave him, after all a dog! He loafed as long as he could pick up some rubbish to eat on the road, but real hunger has driven him back to me, but he will not leave me again. See! I have got this,' and he shook the lead: it was a steel chain this time.

Once again there was the dead, despairing look in the dog's eyes. 'Go on, you fool,' cried the blind man, shouting like an ox-driver. He tugged the chain, poked with the stick, and the dog moved away on slow steps. They stood listening to the tap-tap going away.

'Death alone can help that dog,' cried the ribbon-seller, looking after it with a sigh. 'What can we do with a creature who returns to his doom with such a free heart?'

Pause and Ponder

Ammu: The dog is stupid. Why did it return?

RK: It's not stupid. It is trapped. And it isn't brave enough to survive by itself.

Ammu: I guess it's not easy to break toxic relationships.

RK: Yes! Sometimes it is not easy at all.

Ammu: How will I know I'm not with wrong people?



Theme Shopping for Students

Below are the key themes and objectives to learn from R.K. Narayan's "The Blind Dog". As you understand each one, mark it off.

- Who is R. K. Narayan? Where was he born? What are some of his important works other than "The Blind Dog"?
- Can you summarise the key events of the story and the central characters, especially the relationship between the blind beggar and his loyal dog?
- Have you understood how acts of kindness and compassion influence the characters' lives and relationships in the story?
- Can you examine the dog's loyalty and its desire for freedom, discussing the balance between companionship and independence?
- Can you relate this story with the relationships you have with your peers and friends, and understand what is a healthy relationship, and what is not?

About the Author



R.K. Narayan (1906–2001) was a celebrated Indian author known for his English-language novels. He graduated from the University of Mysore and gained fame with his book *Swami and Friends*. His stories, set in the fictional town of Malgudi, explore

themes like tradition vs. modernity and family life in India, and are written with humour and simplicity. Narayan helped introduce Indian literature in English to the world and is one of India's most respected novelists. He received several prestigious awards, including the Padma Bhushan and Padma Vibhushan, along with the Sahitya Academy Award. His well-known works include *The Guide*, *The Vendor of Sweets*, *Malgudi Days*, and the story *The Missing Mail*.

Summary

The short-story "The Blind Dog," written by R. K. Narayan explores the relationship between a blind beggar and his loyal dog, showcasing the pure and selfless love of animals, and the moral frailty of human beings in comparison with them. At first, their bond reflects the well-known saying that a dog is man's best friend. The beggar feeds the dog, and in return, the dog assists him, guiding him through the marketplace and helping him earn a living. The dog's loyalty is unwavering, going beyond simple companionship to becoming the beggar's eyes and protector. Its actions, driven by trust and love, highlight how even an animal can display qualities of devotion and care that often surpass human behaviour.

However, as the story unfolds, the beggar begins to exploit the dog's loyalty. What was once a partnership turns into an unfair, painful, and a toxic relationship. The dog, tied by its survival instincts and trust, sacrifices its freedom and well-being to serve the beggar. Despite its exhaustion and suffering, it continues to stay by the beggar's side, demonstrating a depth of love that contrasts sharply with the beggar's selfishness. The dog's actions remind us of the pure, unconditional love animals offer, even when it is not deserved. Though the helplessness of the dog is understood through the act of its running away, it comes back without appreciating its freedom enough.

The title, "The Blind Dog," carries a profound double meaning. While it refers to the beggar's physical blindness, it also symbolises his inability to recognise the dog's suffering and the moral blindness in exploiting such a faithful companion. The story ultimately reveals the darker aspects of human nature and elevates the dog as a symbol of true love and loyalty, making it a powerful critique of how humans often fail to reciprocate the pure devotion of animals.

Glossary

- **Auspicious** /ɔ:ˈspiʃəs/ (adjective): Conducive to success; favourable
Usage: They chose an auspicious date for the wedding.
- **Choultry** /ˈtʃaultri/ (noun): A rest house or inn in India
Usage: The travellers stayed at a choultry for the night.
- **Circumscribe** /ˈsɜ:rkəmskraɪb/ (adjective): Restricted or limited
Usage: His activities were circumscribed by strict rules.
- **Elaborate** /ɪˈləbəreɪt/ (adjective): detailed and complicated
Usage: He gave an elaborate description of his trip.
- **Fret** /fret/ (verb): To worry or be anxious
Usage: Don't fret over the small details.
- **Goad** /gəʊd/ (verb): To provoke or annoy someone
Usage: He was goaded into making a decision.
- **Jostle** /ˈdʒɔ:sl/ (verb): To push or shove roughly
Usage: The crowd began to jostle for a better view.
- **Leer** /lɪr/ (verb): To look with a sidelong glance with malicious intent
Usage: He leered at her from across the room.
- **Mongrel** /ˈmʌŋgrəl/ (noun): A dog of no definable type or breed
Usage: The mongrel wagged its tail happily.
- **Mutilate** /ˈmju:tlɪt/ (verb): To severely damage or disfigure
Usage: The ancient statue was mutilated beyond recognition.
- **Pugnacity** /pʌgˈnæsɪti/ (noun): A readiness to fight or argue
Usage: His pugnacity often got him into trouble.
- **Ramble** /ˈræmbəl/ (adjective): Lengthy and confused
Usage: His speech was long and rambling.
- **Rend** /rend/ (verb): To tear something into pieces
Usage: The tragic news seemed to rend their hearts.
- **Scourge** /skɜ:rdʒ/ (noun): A cause of great suffering
Usage: The plague was a scourge that devastated Europe.
- **Skirmish** /ˈskɜ:rmɪʃ/ (noun): A minor fight or clash
Usage: The soldiers had a brief skirmish at dawn.
- **Slack** /slæk/ (adjective): loose, not tight
Usage: The rope was slack and needed to be tightened.
- **Sparse** /spɑ:rs/ (adjective): Thinly dispersed or scattered
Usage: The vegetation was sparse in the desert.
- **Staff** /stæf/ (noun): a walking stick.
Usage: The old man used his staff to help him walk.
- **Treble** /ˈtrebəl/ (verb): to multiply by three
Usage: She trebled her income in just two years.
- **Urchin** /ˈɜ:rtʃɪn/ (noun): A mischievous, poorly dressed young child
Usage: The little urchin darted through the streets.

Essay Questions

Answer the following questions in about 300 words

1. How does the relationship between the blind beggar and the dog evolve throughout the story, and what does this transformation reveal about themes of loyalty, exploitation, and freedom?
2. In which way is the dog's situation an example of an abusive relationship? How does the title "The Blind Dog" symbolize the emotional blindness in their relationship?

Creative Writing

Using the hints provided, write at least ten lines, expanding the ideas into complete sentences. Be creative!

1. A Day in Their Shoes

Idea: Imagine you are a sanitary worker at your college. Write a journal entry describing your day—your work, thoughts, and feelings. Reflect on the challenges you face and what keeps you motivated.

- Hints**
- **Morning:** Start early, clean classrooms, empty trash bins, pick up leftover snacks and papers.
 - **School Activity:** Teachers spill coffee, students litter, run on freshly mopped floors.
 - **Evening:** Tidy up the lunch area, pick up forgotten belongings, sanitize and mop the whole college.
 - **Challenges:** Repetitive tasks, feeling unacknowledged, exhaustion by the end of the day.
 - **Joy:** A simple "thank you," or seeing the college spotless brings quite satisfaction.

2. The Lost Animal

Idea: Imagine an animal that got separated from its home. Write a story about its journey to find its way back. Describe its emotions, the challenges it faces, and how it eventually gets home—or perhaps find a new place to call home.

- Hints**
- **First** – Getting lost – fear, confusion, and loneliness – what the animal feels after realizing it's lost.

- **But** – Finding strength – the animal uses its instincts, learns to survive, and meets new creatures along the way.
- **Then** – Facing obstacles – hunger, wild animals, harsh weather, or dangerous forests – how the animal overcomes these challenges.
- **Later** – Meeting helpful friends – other animals who either guide or help the lost animal.

Write your own story

Can you write a story of your own with the help of the title and the key-words given in the box below? Discuss among yourselves and your teacher, and write a story of your own, and compare it with R. K. Narayan's.

Your 'Blind Dog'

Market, Beggar, Dog, Loyalty, Master, Freedom, Companion, Stick, Abuse, Obedience, Sympathy

My Story

Ammu bids farewell to R. K. Narayan. Back in the Time Machine, Ammu finds a Time Travel Manual and goes through it.

Ammu: This button and this gear might take me back to the forest.

She presses the buttons and pulls the levers.

Ammu: (Speaks to herself) I should do this for Abhi! I should save him.

The time machine starts and stops after a moment. Ammu opens the door and steps out.

Ammu: Wow! Heavens! I did it! The forest! (She looks around and finds no one.) Abhi! I'm back! Where are you? Abhi!

While searching the forest, she identifies the spot where Abhi tripped. There is blood. Beside the blood stains, she finds a familiar object lying in the grass. It's Abhi's torn shoe.

Ammu: (Screams, crying) Abhi!

